

Unit Y319: Civil Rights in the USA 1865–1992

This theme focuses on the struggle of citizens in the United States to gain equality before the law. Learners should understand the factors which encouraged and discouraged change during this period. The strands identified below are not to be studied in isolation to each other.

Learners are not expected to demonstrate a detailed understanding of the specification content, except for the named in-depth studies, but are expected to know the main developments and turning points relevant to the theme.

Thematic Study: Civil Rights in the USA 1865–1992	
Key Topics	Content Learners should have studied the following:
African Americans	Their position in 1865, Reconstruction, white reaction and discrimination; the role of African Americans in gaining civil rights (e.g. Booker T Washington, Dubois, Martin Luther King, the Black Panthers); the roles of Federal (Presidents, Congress and Supreme Court) and State governments in the struggle; the role of anti and pro-civil rights groups; the Civil Rights Movement to 1992.
Trade Union and Labour Rights	Union and Labour rights in 1865; the impact of New Immigration and industrialisation on union development; the role of Federal governments in supporting and opposing union and labour rights; the impact of the World Wars on union and labour rights; the significance of the 1960s; Chavez and the UFW; significance of the Reagan era.
Native American Indians	Their position in 1865; the impact of the Plains Wars (1854–1877); the impact of the Dawes Act 1887, of the acquisition of US citizenship 1924, of the New Deal, of the American Indian Movement in the 1960s and 1970s; Native Americans and the Supreme Court; Native American pressure groups.
Women	Their position in 1865; the impact on women's rights of the campaign for prohibition; the campaign for women's suffrage; the New Deal; the World Wars; the rise of feminism and its opponents, Roe v Wade 1973, the campaign for the Equal Rights Amendment; changing economic and employment opportunities.

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Depth Studies	Content Learners should be aware of debates surrounding the issues outlined for each in-depth topic:
Civil rights in the ‘Gilded Age’ c.1875–c.1895	Nature and extent of progress in civil rights in this era; the varied impact of industrialisation on women, African-Americans and workers, and the nature and effectiveness of their responses; nature and effectiveness of government policy towards civil rights issues including varying attitudes of Presidents, Congress and Supreme Court and State governments; the impact of Westward Expansion on civil rights: Native American Indians, women, workers and African Americans; nature and extent of north-south and east-west divides as they relate to civil rights.
The New Deal and civil rights	Situation of women, African Americans, Native American Indians and workers and trade unions by 1932; Roosevelt and the New Deal – motives as regards minority groups; how far the New Deal improved economic status and civil rights for women, African Americans, Native American Indians and workers and trade unions; nature, extent and effectiveness of opposition to relevant parts of the New Deal especially the Second New Deal and workers’ rights.
Malcolm X and Black Power	Malcolm X as a civil rights leader: aims and motivations, methods, extent of success, and nature and extent of change in these over time; reasons for the rise of Black Power; development of the Black Power movement and impact on other civil rights groups and approaches, such as Non-Violent Direct Action; extent of success of the Black Power movement and its impact on civil rights for African Americans; relationship of Black Power with other civil rights causes, including women and workers.